

M3 flak vest
Made of olive-green cotton duck canvas, the M3 flak vest was armoured on the front only. It was used by crewmen whose seats had armoured backs, like the pilots and the ball-turret gunner.

Footwear
Flying boots were designed to be worn over regular service shoes, which were essential if a crewman bailed out over difficult terrain. The A6 flying boot had an improved tread and a zip instead of buckles.

A10 gloves
For ease of movement, gunners preferred gloves to thick, padded mittens. Rayon inserts were supplied for greater warmth.

A3 trousers
The A3 trousers were made of shearling sheepskin oversprayed with an acrylic lacquer.

B8 backpack parachute
The B8 parachute deployed manually via a rip cord attached to the front of the harness. When bailing out at high altitude a man had to use an emergency oxygen bottle to avoid blacking out on the way down.